PACT

Quantum-sunset protection for Bitcoin holders who cannot move their coins without revealing who they are.

40%

of the funded scope is already delivered, built before the grant round opens.

180

automated checks and conformance vectors, all passing, all runnable offline.

26

conformance vectors, so any independent implementation can be checked against the reference.

The problem. Roughly a third of Bitcoin's supply sits at addresses whose public keys are already visible on the chain. If a future protocol change disables spending from them, a holder must have recorded in advance that they controlled the address. Recording it afterwards is exactly what the change prevents.

The constraint. The obvious way to record it is to move the coins, which is public. For a holder whose safety depends on nobody knowing what they hold, that defeats the purpose. The people most exposed are the ones least able to act.

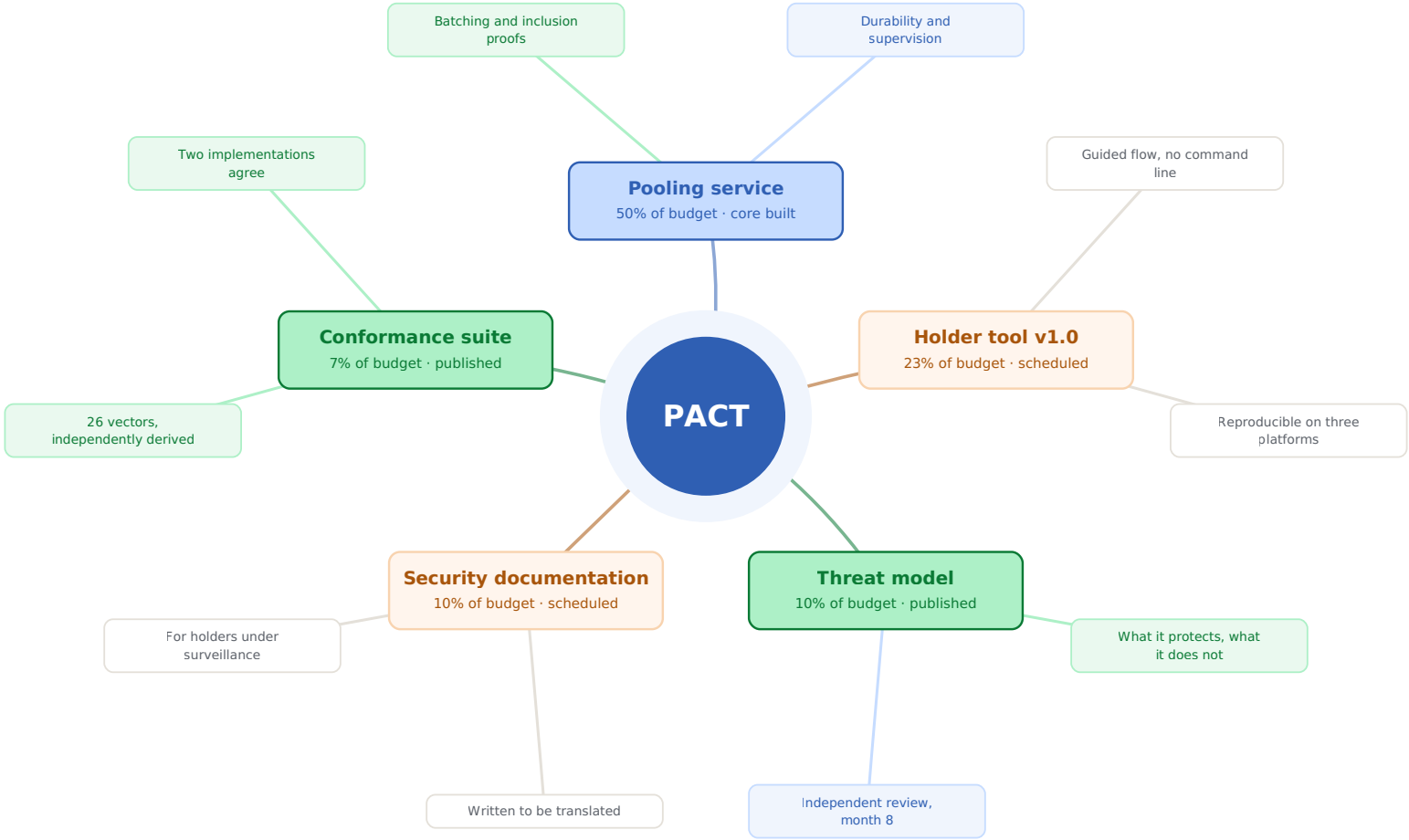
What PACT does. It creates a timestamped record that a holder controlled an address, without revealing which address, how much it holds, or who they are, and without any transaction attributable to them. Open source, MIT licensed.

Status reported against artefacts and tests. Months counted from grant start.

THE PROGRAMME

Five funded deliverables

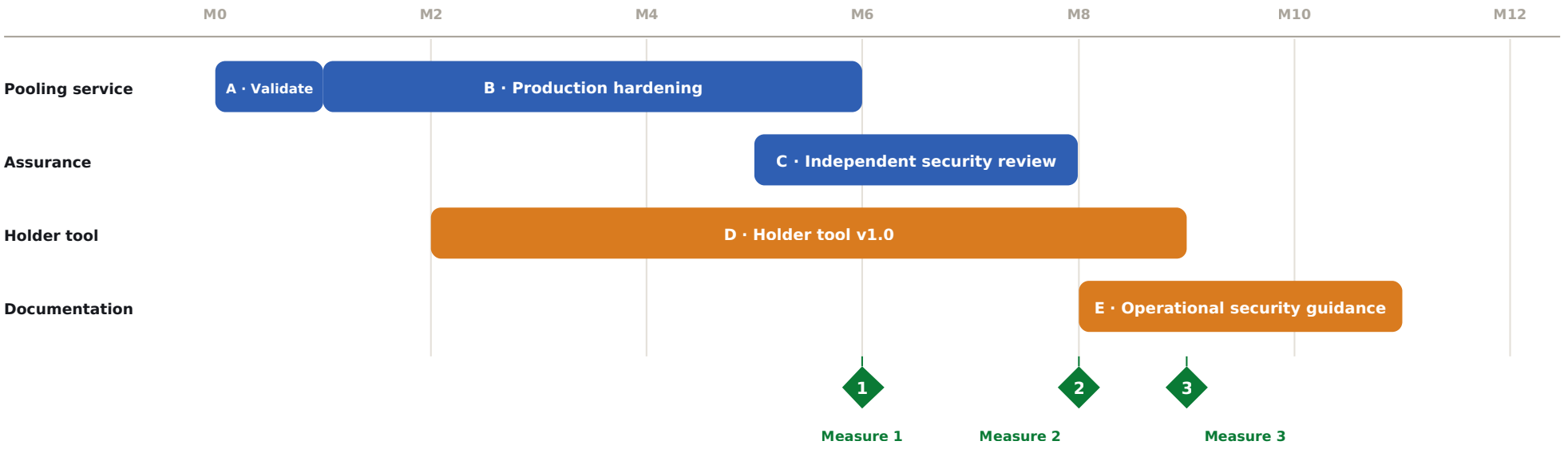
Three are complete or materially under way. The pooling service carries half the budget and half of it is built. Percentages are the budget weights submitted on the application form.



DELIVERY

Timeline and committed measures

Months run from grant start. The two build tracks run in parallel; assurance follows the work it reviews. Diamonds mark the three success measures committed to on the application.



MEASURE 1 · MONTH 6

Pooling service published, running, and reproducible from source by an independent party

Three conditions. Published is a release. Running means an unbroken sequence of sealed intervals a reader can inspect. Independently reproducible means someone who is not the author rebuilds from source and obtains the same artefact.

MEASURE 2 · MONTH 8

Threat model published and reviewed by at least two outside reviewers with security expertise

The document is written and published. The measure's weight sits in the review: a threat model is an argument rather than a measurement, so it cannot be self-certified and the author is the last person able to judge whether it is complete.

MEASURE 3 · AT RELEASE

Holder tool v1.0 released after usability testing with at least five non-technical testers

With the failure modes found and fixed documented. The record has to show what testers got wrong and what changed because of it, which is what makes the result useful to anyone building something similar.

METHOD

How progress is verified

A grant is a claim about the future, so the thing worth offering is a record of how claims get checked. Three practices carried through every stage of the work so far.

01

Every claim traces to an artefact

A harness checks the project's written claims against the files and test results that support them, and fails the build when a document says something the evidence does not. Figures that go stale are caught rather than quietly carried forward.

Runs on every change, and fails the build

02

Specification before implementation

The commitment format is pinned by conformance vectors derived independently of the code that implements it, so an outside developer can check their own build against the reference rather than taking it on trust.

26 vectors · two implementations agree

03

Independent review before release

Finished components are handed to an independent reviewer briefed to test them rather than confirm them. Nothing is released until every finding is closed and covered by a regression test that holds it closed.

Every finding closed and regression-tested

Where your network multiplies the grant

Four steps need people rather than engineering time, and two of them are written into the success measures. Introductions would move these faster than funding alone.

MEASURE 2 · MONTH 8

Two security reviewers

Relevant expertise, outside the project.

MEASURE 1 · MONTH 6

One independent engineer

To rebuild from source and confirm the artefact.

MEASURE 3 · AT RELEASE

Five non-technical holders

For observed usability testing of the holder tool.

DELIVERABLE 4

One field practitioner

Who supports users living under surveillance.